MINUTES OF THE COUNCIL BUDGET WORK SESSION

February 25, 2026

CALL TO ORDER & ROLL CALL: Mayor Cavanaugh called the meeting to order at 3:00 p.m. in the Clarion Room of the Security Bank Building, 1102 Willis Avenue, Perry Iowa. This meeting was also held electronically via a Zoom virtual meeting, meeting ID 816 9514 3220. This meeting was recorded and public access to the virtual meeting was obtainable and published with the agenda and summary.

Council members present were: Shelly arrived at 3:17pm, Mahler, Wolling, Klein, Andorf
Absent: None
A quorum was present to conduct business.

Staff members present:
City Clerk, Elizabeth Hix
Finance Officer, Susie Moorhead
City Administrator, Sven Peterson
Police Chief, Jim Archer
Police Sergeant, Alex Lott
Public Works Director, Josh Wuebker
Parks and Recreation Director, John Anderson
Recreation Assistant Director, Becky Halling
Parks Assistant Director, Mike Peterson
Maintenance Superintendent, Nate Roff
Library Director, Misty Von Behren
Housing and Development Manager, Molly Milosevich
Marketing and Engagement Coordinator, Chris Cohea

Motion Andorf Second Wolling to approve the meeting agenda. Andorf, Wolling, Mahler, Klein

NEW BUSINESS:

Discussion on the FY2027 Budget: Motion Wolling Second Mahler to open the discussion on the FY2027 Budget. The Council reviewed and discussed supplied documents during this time. Finance Officer, Susie Moorhead, provided details on the various budget related items including timelines, Local Option Sales Tax available after debt payments, project closeouts and transfers and the working draft for the budget certification. The meeting then moved into the discussion and review of the capital requests with Department Heads reviewing and detailing their requests for each department as follows:

Parks and Recreation Director, John Anderson, presented the requests for the Hotel Pattee, Recreation Department, Cemetery, Maintenance and Parks.

Library Director, Misty Von Behren, presented the Library requests with maintenance items being discussed with Maintenance Superintendent, Nate Roff.

Public Works Director, Josh Wuebker, presented the requests for Garbage, Public Works, Wastewater Treatment Facility, and the Airport.

Housing and Development Manager, Molly Milosevich, presented the Planning & Zoning request.

City Administrator, Sven Peterson, presented the Fire Department requests.

Police Chief, Jim Archer, presented the Police Department requests with Sergeant Alex Lott, presenting a proposal for a Police K9.

Police Chief Archer also added that Officer Lerch had returned from his recent deployment and was completing some field training before returning to patrol.

With the conclusion of the discussion on capital requests, Susie again reviewed the timeline and discussion was held on the scheduling for some upcoming meetings. It was determined that the next budget work session would be held prior to the March 16th's Regular City Council Meeting at 5:00pm. It was also determined that there would be a work session held with the Iowa DOT on the Highway 141 and Willis/Soumas Ave intersection on March 10th at 1:00pm.

ADJOURNMENT: With no further business to conduct Mayor Cavanaugh adjourned the meeting at 4:48. p.m.

_____
Dirk Cavanaugh, Mayor

Attest:

_____
Elizabeth Hix, City Clerk

Clerk's Certification

Date Published: March 5, 2026

Certified By: _____
Elizabeth Hix, City Clerk